Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

925 sterling silver, planar spiral antenna, secure cryptographic element
Founding Edition · 10 numbered pieces

The premise

A signet ring puts a person's mark on a document. For thousands of years that is how people showed a decision was their own: by hand, with a mark only they held.

Today a name is typed or a box is ticked, and software increasingly writes and acts for us. It is becoming harder to tell what a person actually decided.

Signet 01 brings the signet to digital writing. It is a ring that signs.

The instrument

Signet 01 is investment-cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand at the bench. We chose silver because it is the most conductive metal and a traditional material for signets.

The face carries a twelve-turn square spiral, which is both the ring's mark and its antenna. Held to a phone, the spiral draws energy from the phone's field and powers a secure element seated beneath it. There is no battery and no charging.

The secure element holds a single private key, generated on the chip. The key cannot be exported, so the ring can sign without the key ever leaving it.

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The seal

Signet 01 signs written words.

Write your words and read them through. Touch the ring to your phone to sign them.

The ring can also sign a file, such as an image or a PDF. An encrypted file can be signed too: anyone can check the seal, but only those with the key can open the file.

A seal is a permanent record on a public ledger that these exact words were signed by this ring at this time. It carries the holder's name as entered in the Register. If one character or one byte changes, the seal no longer matches.

Each seal has its own address. It can be sent, quoted or kept, and anyone with the address can read the words and check who signed them and when. Every seal a ring makes is listed, in order, under that ring's entry in the Register.

What you sign is up to you: a declaration, a dedication, a letter to be opened later, an approval.

What a seal proves

A seal proves three things.

1. This ring signed these exact words. Anyone can check the signature against the ring's public key using open standards, without involving HANNON TAN.
2. When it was signed. The ledger records the time.
3. Who holds the ring. The Register links each numbered piece to its holder of record and records every change of holder.

A seal does not prove that the holder read the words carefully, or that the ring was on the right hand. As with any signet, it relies on the owner keeping the ring safe. If a ring is lost or stolen, it is revoked in the Register.

The Register

The Register is the record of every numbered piece. It holds the origin of the metal, the casting date, the makers, the holder of record and each change of holder, the ring's key and every authorised change to that key.

The ledger shows which ring signed. The Register shows whose ring it is. They are separate: anyone can verify a seal without the Register, and the Register can be read without revealing what has been sealed.

Seals stay with the ring. If a holder passes a ring on, the Register records the transfer, the ring keeps its full list of seals, and each seal keeps the name of the holder who made it.

Status: the sealing application, the verification page, the Register and the studio service are in development. This monograph describes them as designed.

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The Founding Edition

Ten numbered pieces. Delivery from the first quarter of 2027.

The Founding Edition is the first ten Signets. Their holders are the first ten names in the Register. Each holder receives:

- Signet 01, numbered 01 to 10, hallmarked, cast in New Zealand and finished in Adelaide, sized to the hand.
- A unique signing key, generated inside the ring at assembly and recorded in the Register.
- An entry in the Register under the holder's name, with the origin of the metal and the casting date.
- The First Seal: the holder's first words, sealed at handover as the first entry in that ring's record.
- A numbered monograph and a certificate of the ring's key, signed by Jim Hannon-Tan.
- A case made for the ring.
- A profile on the public ledger in the holder's name, which holds the ring's entry.
- Studio service, as set out below.

Later editions will be larger. There will be only one Founding Edition.

Service

The silver body will last longer than the electronics, so the ring is designed to be serviced.

- The secure element is a replaceable calibre. When cryptographic standards change, the studio fits a new one and the silver body, hallmark and number stay the same. The change is recorded in the Register. Service is charged when performed.
- Seals made under an earlier key remain valid.
- A lost or stolen ring is revoked in the Register at the holder's request. Anything it signs afterwards does not carry the holder's name. A replacement is made under the same number with a new key, and the Register links it to the original.
- Verification does not depend on HANNON TAN. The standards are open and the seals are on a public ledger.

There is no subscription.

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Provenance

Signet 01 grew from Near Field Circuit, Genesis Edition (2025): ten seals CNC-machined from solid brass, copper-plated and hand-assembled, each carrying an Arx HaLo chip bonded to an LSP8 token on LUKSO. A tap recorded presence and ownership to the holder's Universal Profile. All ten were sold and are held by collectors around the world.

nearfieldcircuit.com

Near Field Circuit was supported by the LUKSO Grants Program, and the ring's software builds on that work. Signet 01 has been developed with ANFF-C Gate 1 funding and with the support of the Australian National Fabrication Facility.

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer. His work ranges from everyday and cultural objects to medical technology and digital instruments, for clients including Alessi and Schneider Electric. He spent fifteen years working in Milan, Amsterdam and London and is now based in Adelaide, Australia.

Makers

Industrial design	Jim Hannon-Tan
Casting	Morris & Watson, New Zealand
Bench work	Shannon Cornish Artisan Jewellers
Vitreous enamel R&D	JamFactory, Adelaide
Mechanical engineering	Varghese Liju
Electronic engineering	Aaron Mohtar
RF and antenna consultancy	Dr Shengjian Chen, Flinders University
Ledger and application	Aureliano Alarcón Smith

With thanks to Cameron Robertson, founder of Arx, and Fabian Vogelsteller, co-founder of LUKSO.

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Technical specifications

Chassis	925 sterling silver, investment cast, hand finished, hallmarked and numbered
Antenna	Integrated 12-turn planar square spiral · 13.56 MHz · tuned to the chassis
Secure element	Arx HaLo passive NFC · no battery
Key	ECDSA secp256k1 · generated on-silicon · non-exportable
Message format	EIP-712 typed structured data · the ring signs the digest of the exact text, or of the exact file
Register	One LSP8 collection on LUKSO, ten tokens · each token is a ring's entry, held by the holder's Universal Profile
Seal	An LSP8 token owned by the ring's Register token, carrying the signature, the digest, the timestamp and the text or the file's digest
Identity	A LUKSO Universal Profile (ERC-725) in the holder's name, set up at issuance
Verification	Open · recover the signer from the signature and compare to the ring's public key, with no dependence on HANNON TAN
Serviceability	Secure element seated as a replaceable calibre · chassis and number persist across calibre changes

Allocation

Jim reads and answers every request personally. A deposit confirms an allocation, with the balance due at delivery. The first casting closes 15 December 2026.

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